

Lions to 'blitz' town with pumpkin drive Sept. 20

By Ryland Coyne
Gazette news editor

Get ready Almonte, the annual pumpkin blitz is coming Sept. 20.

With Halloween just around the corner, the local Lions club is planning to swamp the town with pumpkins once again this year to raise money for its local projects.

From 9 a.m. to 12 noon, members and their helpers will go door-to-door offering a selection of the fall time favorites to local residents. Organizer Gerry Theoret said last week the Lions Club does not put a price on the big orange vegetables preferring to leave it up to each customer to make a donation.

"People generally donate around three, four, or five dollars, depending upon how large a pumpkin they get," he said.

A group of Lions will also be 'selling' pumpkins off a cart downtown on Mill Street near Peterson's Ice Cream plant throughout the morning.

In all, Mr. Theoret said he hopes to sell between 400 and 500 pumpkins, the majority of which through the door to door campaign.

"That's (door-to-door) a big feature for a lot of people. It's not a lot of hassle," he said. "I get a sense that people like to get the pumpkins as much for the convenience as for supporting the Lions."

He said the pumpkin event is the second or third best fundraiser for the club along with the annual lamb races (Waterfall Wool Flotilla) during the Ice Cream Festival and the Christmas Tree sales.



Carving contest revived
In addition to the pumpkin sales, this

year also marks the return of the great pumpkin carving contest.

Mr. Theoret said he had lined up at least five contestants by last week (one each from town council, Lions club, Gazette, Mississippi Valley Textile Museum, and Heritage Regions project) and hopes for between eight and 10 by Sept. 20.

The rules are simple. "The pumpkin has to be carved on the spot and you have to bring your own tools," said Mr. Theoret. Otherwise anything goes.

The winning carver will receive an as yet undisclosed prize from Peterson's Ice Cream.

Snowy history

No matter how hard they try to make it stay away, Mr. Theoret said old man winter always seems to drop a load of snow on pumpkin blitz day. Despite the slush, however, he said the money raised from the event for local projects makes all the work worthwhile.

"That's why we're out there slipping and sliding on these selling pumpkins," he said with a smile.

Cedar Hill W.I. members recount trip to England

Cedar Hill W.I. met Oct. 1 at the home of Mrs. Betty Neil with 18 ladies present. We entertained Union Hall W.I.

Mrs. Alma Majaur and Jo Ann Camelon of Waba and White Lake W.I. told the group of being entertained in England last August by W.I. there. Four ladies from White Lake W.I. got their invitation to visit England at the area convention in Ottawa last year.

Billeted with a retired school teacher and his wife, they visited Windsor Castle, the Tower of London, Dickens Inn, Westminster Abbey, and saw Big Ben and the House of Parliament in London. They found the Thames River to be no wider than the Mississippi River here. The calendars they were given contained pages that would fold up into post cards. They also visited the

White Cliffs of Dover and Ontario Place. Mrs. Majaur showed slides and Jo Ann commented on them. The flowers hanging from boxes on hotel fronts were beautiful.

Queen Elizabeth and her mother are both members of W.I.

White Lake ladies made many good friends and bid farewell to England with tears and happy memories.

In England they have waiting lists to become W.I. members. Roll call - 'Are you in for Sunday shopping?' - Everyone at the meeting voted it down.

The Ottawa Area Convention is at the Talisman Motor Inn Oct. 15 to 16. Guest speakers are Rev. Donald McDonald and Rev. Sandra McDonald.

The next W.I. meeting will be at Muriel Lawson's house.

ADHS group "tackles" the environment

A group of high school students have united to raise money for the environment.

STEM (students tackling environmental matters) said last week it plans to raise \$600 to buy 400 trees which will be planted around town. The students will plant the trees (sugar maple, red oak, white pine and white spruce), 350 of which will be set aside for homeowners (a maximum of five apiece) and 50 for town property.

In a written statement, its members state their goal is "to beautify the town of Almonte, help environment, prove to adults that teenagers can do anything we set our minds to, to encourage further planting of trees in and around Almonte."

The group plans to raise the money via leaf raking (this coming weekend, call 256-3867 to register), bake sales, car washes, dance concessions, etc. It stressed it would not ask for money from businesses, but rather seek donations from local citizens.

STEM members will be going door-to-door on the weekend offering to rake lawns and bag leaves. Watch for them!

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